

Faith That Pleases God

Open to Genesis 9.

Part of our transformation is training ourselves in the renewing of our mind to prove what is that good, acceptable, and perfect will of God. Being born again and receiving a new nature absolutely set us free. He said sin shall not have dominion over you, for you are not under law but under grace.

For sin to lose all of its dominion happened in the position we received as His sons and daughters when we received His nature. That new life we have, He says, is the ordained strength out of the mouth of babes and sucklings, these newborn creatures, us, to still our enemies. That ordained strength comes from the new nature and the inheritance we have received as sons and daughters of God.

I have learned the language of faith, the very strong language of faith. I believe that stuff, and it is becoming stronger and stronger in me by the moment.

The language of faith we have been taught as faith people says:

He that cometh to God must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of them that diligently seek Him.

If you do not believe that He is, then where are you going to get what you need to stay in for the reward? You have to settle in yourself what you became when sin lost dominion and you became a new creation, His son or daughter.

Most of us have learned the language of faith, and some of us are pretty clinical about it. We have come to understand the Word: it is forever settled in heaven and earth. He exalted His Word even above His name. Heaven and earth will pass, but His Word will remain the same.

Some of us do not know God very well, but we know what He said about different things, so we take that Word and begin to confess it. Sometimes we are not transformed in certain areas. People do not know what He said about sin. Some who believe in eternal security mean they can live any way they want, as long as they want, with no consequence because their righteousness is separate from their flesh. They believe there is no overcoming the flesh because it is separate, so you are saved no matter what you do.

Around that, we will take teachings like faith and approach them clinically, almost antiseptically. We scrub them clean and just say it and say it and say it.

Once a person enters into a relationship with God, a lot of things change.

I have seen people die many times while confessing His Word, because the disease outran the time they had left to confess. Many of those people did not have much relationship, just an antiseptic, clinical walk: "I did what I am supposed to do, and God is supposed to heal me."

They tried to confess it and outrun the disease. Some made it, and some did not.

The ones who did make it, when I talked to them later, usually had a relationship. If they did not, and they were accountable and heard the Word and heard it and heard it, somewhere along the way, walking the floor in faith for two or three hours as Norvel taught, they began to know Him. You cannot do that without Him coming because of your confession and beginning to deal with the things wrong between you and Him that are keeping you from being healed.

When I entered into worship, the pendulum began to swing toward a faith my senses were not able to stop. There are areas I am still learning in, but in many areas now, in my body and different things, I feel better than I ever have. Even compared with my late twenties and thirties, I feel better now. My body is more pain-free than it was then.

Some areas I have had to learn more about, and I am conquering them now, because I trusted teachers to the nth degree in some areas that I am now having to change, mostly involving covenant, finances, sonship, and inheritance. I was taught wrong for a lot of years, and I am busy changing that now so we will have enough to finance the world.

I certainly cannot draw that from any man's bank. It does not look too likely right now, but do not forget this: if the Lord tarries, I have a good thirty years left. Hang on.

You cannot start speaking His Word without Him also dealing with things between you and Him that are keeping you from receiving what you are not getting.

When I began to worship, it tilted my senses. It brought them into agreement with what the Word said because my senses were not able to resist as hard when His presence began to come and baptize them. I got to know my Father better and better.

I learned the language of confession, but let me show you some adjustments He made. This is how I do it now:

"I worship You and glorify You for being so faithful, for being such a faithful Redeemer. I want to thank You so much for paying the price for healing me. Lord God, I praise You and thank You. Therefore, I can say with utmost boldness: I am healed."

See, my confession took on relationship, instead of an antiseptic, clinical, "I am going to live like I want, and it is Your job to heal me."

One of the greatest things that has happened is that all the tapes I have, and all of them have served through the years, different revelations serving until they finally came together. There was enough information and foundation in me for the mystery of being born again, or what we call the born-again trail, to fall into my spirit.

I understand now that this is the next generation of revelation He is able to put on every other tape I have.

It is funny. After teaching in conferences, I will stand there and watch people run to the tape table. Depending on what I taught, there will be a feeding frenzy. They all come in getting those basic beginning tapes, The Walk of the Spirit, Why Tongues, Tongues for the Believer, all those basic ones, because that is where they are.

I am standing there looking at this big massive series on the table, The Born-Again Trail, volumes one, two, three, and four, thinking, "Boy, they could save themselves a lot of time." But they pass them by. The second or third time I begin to talk about them, people start coming in. Guess which ones change their lives in the next step? The Born-Again Trail teachings we have been doing.

These mornings, I am still delivering what He dropped into my spirit. I cannot tell you how long it was, fifteen or twenty minutes, but I am still coming out here because everything I am telling you is based on what happened that day when He dropped this trail in me and opened it up. The rest has opened up based on what He gave me that day. It is all connected.

That is when He took me back into the Old Testament and began to show me my Father's nature, which I had missed back there.

In the Old Testament, I had almost totally missed His nature, His mercy, grace, and tender lovingkindness. It was hard for me to believe that He respected and loved every human being.

I looked at the human race more like a colony of ants. They were all just running around, and it was His job as God and Creator to save us and offer salvation to us. Throughout time, He picked out certain ones to bestow special blessings on, and the rest, like Old Testament saints lost in the regions of North America or Africa, were just out there. It was tough for them. Evidently they were not worth as much as Abraham or Moses because He just left them out there. They lived and died, and it seemed okay because there were plenty of them, like ants.

It was hard to believe He could really love anybody born anywhere as much as He loved Abraham, as much as He loved Moses, as much as He loved Jesus. But Jesus said the love the Father loved Him with, He loves you with.

It is hard to understand that He really loves every human being, because under the Old Testament it looks like He left them out and they went their ways. He just seemed to neglect them for a thousand years or so, dealing with one little pocket while the rest died and died.

Then suddenly He comes to the cross, redeems us, and does all these special things for us. How can you really have faith in Him if He did that to all the rest? It seems like He is going to let you down somewhere.

Of course, if you pray in tongues enough, you will think into all those areas because faith comes by hearing. What we have done with the blank spots is say, "Who knows the hidden things of God?" and cover them up, even taking those verses out of context. But he said those hidden things have been revealed to us by His Spirit.

When He was ready to open the Old Testament to me, it was after I had received enough revelation from the new and the born-again trail. It afforded me enough understanding that He could take me back and cause me to understand more about this God who would declare war through the Israelites, send them in to wipe out nations and families, and wipe out the early world.

You want to talk about the mercy of God? Mercy took place when He reduced the whole world back down to one family and tried to fill the whole earth with the knowledge of God again.

I can tell you why He wiped the early world out. All flesh had gone its way. He did not wipe it out because of the adults. He wiped the early world out because the whole earth was overrun, and there were whole generations of children being born under every perverted circumstance. Children are always the victims.

The whole world was not only overrun with adults who went their way, but there were probably more children below the age of accountability than at any time in the history of the world. I tell you who He had mercy on: He probably sent as many children to heaven as there were adults alive on the earth when He flooded it.

He reduced everything down to one family. Who can argue that the knowledge of God was in the whole earth then? What a merciful, tender, loving God.

Noah's sons were Shem, Ham, and Japheth, and the bloodline to Christ followed Shem. When Noah's ark landed, the first thing he did was take of the clean beasts. The unclean animals had been taken in by twos, but the clean beasts by sevens. More than likely, they were paired off, and because seven is an uneven number, one was left over to be offered in sacrifice.

Noah gathered his family around him: Ham, Shem, Japheth, their wives, and the children. He gathered them around an altar he built, and he sacrificed. God taught him, and Noah taught them what to do and how to replenish the earth. God's intention was for them to walk with Him.

But the devil got in. He followed each lineage, tracked them down, and perverted their worship and service to God again. But it is not that God did not try. He did.

I am so full of awe, confidence, faith, and surety. I believe that He is. I believe He is who He said He is. Therefore I am in line for a reward. You must believe that He is and that He is a rewarder. If you cannot believe He is who He said He is, as we have proven time after time in religion, you will not have enough courage to stay in for the reward. You will bail out somewhere because you do not know Him, you are not convinced He is who He said He is, and you do not know His Word. So you wear out and do not receive.

Hallelujah. Glory be to God.

Now my worship and confession are different. How can I say thanks? If You would make this kind of provision, oh Jesus, You provided healing for me. How can I say thanks? You love me so much that You Yourself bore my sicknesses and carried my pains. So I have something to say: I am healed.

For five or six years here, I tilted my back out. The vertebrae pressed against my spinal column. Sometimes I would almost have to drag my leg around because the pain hurt so badly. It would go back in, only for a wrong move to put it back out. That happened for years. I often wondered if God gave me an airplane to leave my back like that.

Then I had an infection run through my system for a year. I do not know what caused it, but during that time my system was weak enough that almost everything that came along, I would get it. Sometimes I would walk out as sick as a dog. By the time the anointing came during prayer, it would lift off me and I could do the whole service, but afterward I would be sick again.

Still, I have not missed one single service in twenty-eight years for sickness, sometimes averaging forty a month, because I just would not lay down. Sometimes I would start out crawling, but I would make it. Sometimes the front row was in danger if I reversed peristalsis, but I would make it.

Then a growth came up on my side, and I had to fight that for a long time. I remember when He healed me. I was stepping down off a step, and He said, "Are you going to do something?" I was consecrated. I had made up my mind to do what He said, and I did. He knew I did. Then He said it was over, and it disappeared in two days.

I have passed blood in my urine, but I have never known what caused it. All I know is that once I was sick, and now I am not.

Thank You, Jesus.

He that comes to God must believe that He is. If you do not settle it, you are going to be overpowered by everything.

God may want me to go to the Amazon and go up some fork of the river. I cannot take a doctor with me. I just have to go.

Amen.

I get a kick out of people who make everything else their problem. If they had different children, different this or different that. Little Johnny controls the family.

"I am going to leave because of this or because of that."

What if God asked you to go out on a fork of the Amazon, and every day a witch doctor walked by your hut trying to decide whether to knock on your timber with a machete? What is little Johnny going to do then? Is he going to control your life? Who is going to teach little Johnny? You. Who is going to be in charge of his spiritual upbringing?

"This is the best Word we have heard, but little Johnny does not have a puppet show, so we are leaving."

I have news for you. Puppet shows are not going to cause him to turn out right. You are. Not them. You.

Hallelujah.

You are supposed to start training them about moving in the Holy Spirit when they are little. Big Bird cannot do as good as you can.

Am I against that? No, not if it teaches them about the move of the Spirit and God, not if it does not replace it.

"I just cannot bring my kids and make them sit in the row."

Of course you cannot. How can you do that when you miss church over anything yourself? You are not going to fight for your kids to hear it when you do not care that much yourself.

Of course, I am not talking to you. You are in the early service. I am talking to everybody listening to this tape.

Hallelujah.

I meant to get further than this, but that is habitual with me. Maybe I could have gotten this born-again trail out in a year and a half, but the Head of the Church keeps coming and wanting to talk. I found out that when He finds a mouth, He will wear it out.

Hallelujah.

Prophecy serves for edification, exhortation, and comfort. You cannot exhort unless it is based on something. Exhortation is expounding on something that already exists. When He comes and wants to expound between the lines on verses and things, I am going to let Him do it. I can tell when it is Him.

Most of this service has been one of those times He wanted to talk about how much He loves you, and about His tender mercies and kindness. There is nobody out there anywhere, on any isolated island, whom He did not love as much as Abraham, Adam, and anybody else.

He said if you do not understand that, it will be hard for you to have faith and confidence in God. When He said He healed you, He healed you. He sealed it, accomplished it for you, and gave it to you two thousand years ago. He meant it, and you can have it.

You who come to Him for it must believe that He is who He said He is and that He is a rewarder. If you do not believe it is eternally settled and yours, where are you going to get the courage to stay in for the reward? You will abort. The first little wind that comes along, the devil will push you over, and you will run somewhere for someone to patch you and tell you it is God's will. Then you will not be able to help the generations that follow you.

Let us look at His tender love, mercy, and kindness here.

Genesis 7:2 says:

Of every clean beast thou shalt take to thee by sevens, the male and his female: and of beasts that are not clean by two, the male and his female.

None of the unclean animals were going to be sacrificed. The clean beasts and clean fowls came by sevens, to keep seed alive upon the face of all the earth.

By Genesis 9, the ark had landed:

And God blessed Noah and his sons, and said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth.

Notice this, just after he sacrificed:

And the fear of you and the dread of you shall be upon every beast of the earth...
Every moving thing that liveth shall be meat for you; even as the green herb have I given you all things.
But flesh with the life thereof, which is the blood thereof, shall ye not eat.

They were not to eat any animal with the blood in it, because the life was in the blood. That life had to be poured out for them as atonement. They could not consume it themselves. There had to be atoning.

Under that covenant He made with them, He said the dread of them would be on every beast. You talk about authority. Why would you and I have anything less? We have been delivered into what all of this was about, which is the new nature. The life in the blood was a type of the life in Jesus' spirit that you and I have received. That was just the shadow and type, yet the dread of every animal was upon them.

If they did not heed what He said, they would be tracked down by every animal. If they shed man's blood, then man would shed their blood.

Genesis 9:4 says:

But flesh with the life thereof, which is the blood thereof, shall ye not eat.

Then:

And surely your blood of your lives will I require; at the hand of every beast will I require it, and at the hand of man...
Whoso sheddeth man's blood, by man shall his blood be shed: for in the image of God made He man.

If they stepped out from underneath that blood, if they ate their animals or sacrifices with the atoning blood in them which had not been offered, then He said He would require their life at the hands of every beast.

I have heard of men who went into the wilderness and had no weapons. There were men of old times, a hundred years ago or more, who had camp meetings called brush arbors. Somebody told the story of a man preaching who went out into the woods and ordered a blackbird to come down and land on his hand, and it did.

One man went out daydreaming, walking across a cow pasture and worshiping. He looked up and saw a bull at a dead run toward him. He turned around, pointed his finger at it, and said, "I rebuke you in the name of Jesus. Stop!" That bull skidded to a stop, shook his head as if wondering what in the world had happened, and left.

This is interesting to me because of how Noah gathered his family and gave them this.

Genesis 8:15 says:

And God spake unto Noah, saying,
Go forth of the ark, thou, and thy wife, and thy sons, and thy sons' wives with thee.
Bring forth with thee every living thing that is with thee...

Then:

And Noah builded an altar unto the LORD; and took of every clean beast, and of every clean fowl, and offered burnt offerings on the altar.

That is when the Lord entered into covenant with them and gave the instructions. He blessed Noah and his sons and told them to be fruitful. Then He said:

But flesh with the life thereof, which is the blood thereof, shall ye not eat.

And if they did not continue in the sacrifices Noah taught them, their life would be required.

Shem gets all the attention because the bloodline followed him. Job's people came through Shem's bloodline too. Job lived sometime around Abraham's time. But God did not come to Job and give him the instructions He gave to Abraham. To Abraham He said this thing would continue to follow his lineage: Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, Judah, Pharez, Hezron, Amminadab, Nahshon, Salmon, Boaz, Obed, Jesse, David, Solomon, Rehoboam, Abijah, Asa, Jehoshaphat, and on down to Jesus.

Just because the bloodline did not follow Ham and Japheth does not mean they did not receive the same instructions Shem received for blood sacrifice. God told them that all the food they caught, they were to shed the blood and pour it out. He said, "If you do not do this, your life will be

required at the hands of every beast. If you shed man's blood, man will come and shed yours."

If I were Ham, Shem, or Japheth, I think I would set up some kind of law and pass that law on to my children: know the Lord God, build altars, and if anyone refuses, put an end to that and teach the children. Salvation would have followed each bloodline.

But it did not take Satan long. When Noah woke up from celebrating his vineyard and knew what his younger son, really his grandson, had done to him, curses began immediately. Satan did not wait long.

In Hebrews 11, when he was teaching about the faith by which the Old Testament elders obtained a good report, he said:

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for...

By it the elders obtained a good report. They framed their worlds and changed their generations with it. But at the end of Hebrews 11 he went on to say:

That they without us should not be made perfect.

That kind of faith they walked in obtained a good report, but they without us and our dispensation of the rebirth should not be made perfect.

Then in Hebrews 12 he says:

Looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith...

They obtained a good report, but now that He has come and given you the inheritance and a new nature, we look to the Author and Finisher of our faith. Where they received a good report, we received an inheritance.

The whole world can be reclaimed in our dispensation, and He has given us an inheritance to do it with. You need to look to the Author and Finisher of your faith now, because you are a son of God. Nobody else can finish you but Him.

We are capable of things we cannot even dream of, and you will never have them until you look to the Author and Finisher of your faith, get to know Him, and let Him, through that new nature, get the world out of you.

You are not dependent on animal sacrifice with the sin nature. It was impossible for the blood of goats and bulls to take away sin. Not you. Jesus offered Himself by the eternal Spirit. You mean the Holy Spirit? No. He offered Himself for you by the eternal spirit that was in Him. His human spirit was made to be your sin, and the life that was in Him is now in you.

You can look to the Author and Finisher of your faith. You are supposed to walk like the finished product. The dread of animals over you? Are you kidding? You should rule and reign with Him. He wants you to go to every dark continent, every region of darkness, and walk like He walked, with the better promise as a son and daughter of God and a full inheritance.

What are you afraid of?

Hebrews 1 says again:

God, who at sundry times and in divers manners spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets,
Hath in these last days spoken unto us by His Son...

There is only one communication to God and from God in these last days, and that is through the Author and Developer of your faith. He is the only One the Holy Spirit will reveal.

...by whom also He made the worlds;
Who being the brightness of His glory, and the express image of His person...

Then it gets very interesting:

Being made so much better than the angels, as He hath by inheritance obtained a more excellent name than they.

He obtained a more excellent name through inheritance because He is His Son.

What did He say to the angels?

Who maketh His angels spirits, and His ministers a flame of fire.

They were made. You were born. They are servants. You are sons and daughters, servants by choice. Jesus, in His humanity, received a more excellent name than they through inheritance because He is His Son.

Hebrews 2:11 says:

For both He that sanctifieth and they who are sanctified are all of one: for which cause He is not ashamed to call them brethren.

He who sanctifies, Jesus, and you who are sanctified are all of one, the Father. For this reason, He is not ashamed to call you His brother.

All the inheritance He has, He is the Author and Finisher of your faith. You should learn to walk like Him.

The old covenant, that first promise God made, should have been passed down through Ham, Shem, and Japheth. They should have passed law, stopped anyone who stepped out of those sacrifices, and carried it down each bloodline, each continent. Every one of us would have been connected and waiting for the promise of Abraham.

Hallelujah.

I am His son. I am His son. It is time that we return to that place of authority He gave us in creation.

Stand up. I have to stop.